

UTT Chapter 16 Assignment

Hello there!

Best break idea ever? Hiking the Appalachian Trail with Mark, Nathan, and Muhammad. With backpacks, trail mix, and sleeping bags in tow, we spent about ten days on the trail. It was probably the most adventurous retreat I have ever taken. We caught our own food, cooked it over a campfire, and slept under the stars. It was an amazing bonding experience. We saw a lot of wildlife and flora that Nathan, our resident biologist, identified for us. Good thing he was there, because I almost ate poisonous berries! It was a welcome break from the stress of classes and campaigning.

Speaking of classes, my professors are already talking about final papers and exams. For my macroeconomics class, the students are required to write a paper on what they think is the ideal economic system. Before I began the class, I heard that the free market system was the most ideal. My professor, however, seemed to favor a lot of government intervention to help with the distribution of wealth. He didn't actually say he favored socialism, but I believe that is his leaning. He portrayed capitalism as a greedy, manipulative system where the rich oppress everyone else. Going into this final paper, I no longer have any idea which economic system is the most biblical. Nathan and I were talking about it for a while during the hike, but he didn't help me out too much. If I understood him correctly, he believed that we all have the potential to become rich and successful if we only ask the universe!

Hearing us talk about economics, Mark jumped right into the conversation. He said that a market-oriented economy, like capitalism, is a chaotic system only useful for exploiting the poor. He talked about socialism as the solution. Somehow, socialism will lead to the establishment of communism. Mark even suggested that socialism is consistent with the teachings of Christianity. I'm not sure how that works exactly, but we are called to care for the poor, right?

I know Sarah and Mark sometimes agree on these worldview matters. Have you heard anything about this in your worldview class? **What is the Secularist view of economics?** Also, **what is the Marxist view?**

Nathan's views were probably the most confusing. **What is the role of economics in New Spirituality?** Perhaps my biggest concern is not knowing which economic system is the most consistent with Christianity. I can't remember if economics is even addressed in the Bible. **Are there any biblical principles of economics, and if so, what are they?**

Thanks for all your help. You are a lifesaver! Boy, am I glad that you had a worldview class to help me out with all this. Hopefully I will have time to write again soon. With finals and elections coming up, I'm not sure I will even have time to sleep!

See ya later!

-Doug